

Musical instruments

Innovative instruments have brought
MUSIC to the ears of the masses

Musical instruments have existed since prehistoric times. As materials and designs have evolved, primitive versions have been fine-tuned, while new models strike a chord with musicians and audiences alike.

Keyboard

For centuries, keyboards were used to play organ pipes. But in the 15th century, they began to be used to play **strings**, and the **HARPSICHORD** was born. Pressing a key plucked a string, with each string playing a note. The **piano** arrived in the 18th century, with its sophisticated keyboard of **WHITE AND BLACK** keys. Pianos use hammers to strike the strings, so the notes can be played loudly or quietly depending on how hard the key is pressed.



This ornate, painted harpsichord was made in Antwerp in 1643.

A Stradivarius violin sold in 2011 for a massive \$15.9 million.



Violin

The smallest, **highest-pitched** member of the string family is the violin.

Developed in the 16th century, the invention is usually attributed to Italian **ANDREA AMATI**, who made an early version to entertain King Charles IX of

France. The instrument was enhanced over the following two centuries into the **wooden wonder** we know today. This example was made by famous Italian violin-maker Antonio Stradivari in 1709.